

Remote Work IT Policy

1. Purpose

This policy defines the IT security and operational requirements for Summit IT Services employees working outside of a Summit IT office - including from home offices, client sites, co-working spaces, hotels, or any other remote location. The policy ensures that remote work does not increase the risk of data breaches, unauthorized access, or compliance failures.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All full-time employees, part-time employees, contractors, and temporary workers performing work duties outside of a Summit IT Services office.
- All company-issued devices (Dell Latitude 7440 laptops, MacBook Pro 14" laptops, company mobile devices).
- All access to Summit IT Services systems, applications, and data from remote locations.
- Home network setups and temporary remote locations (hotels, airports, cafes, client sites).

Personal device use while remote is additionally governed by POL-004 (BYOD & Mobile Device Policy).

3. Policy Statements

3.1 Approved Devices for Remote Work

3.1.1 Remote access to Summit IT Services internal systems must be performed exclusively from **company-issued, IT-managed devices** (enrolled in Intune for Windows or Jamf Pro for macOS). Access from unmanaged personal computers to internal systems is prohibited without an approved BYOD exception under POL-004.

3.1.2 Company laptops must not be used by family members, housemates, or any person other than the assigned employee, regardless of location.

3.1.3 Employees must never leave company devices unattended in vehicles, public spaces, or hotel rooms without engaging the device lock screen. Devices should be stored securely (e.g., in a locked bag) when not in use away from home.

3.1.4 Any loss or theft of a company device must be reported to the IT Service Desk within **2 hours** of discovery, 24/7, by calling +1 (800) 555-7866. The SOC will initiate remote wipe and account review procedures.

3.2 VPN Requirements

3.2.1 **GlobalProtect VPN** must be connected before accessing any Summit IT Services internal application, file share, or system from outside the office network. This includes:

Resource	VPN Required?
Internal web apps and intranet sites	Yes - always
SharePoint / OneDrive (external access)	No - protected by Okta + MFA + Conditional Access
Microsoft 365 (Outlook, Teams, Office)	No - protected by Okta + MFA + Conditional Access
Slack, Zoom	No - cloud SaaS; protected by Okta SSO
SummitDesk (https://help.summitit.com)	No - cloud-hosted; accessible without VPN
RDP / SSH to internal servers	Yes - GlobalProtect required
AWS internal resources	Yes - GlobalProtect or AWS Client VPN (as applicable)

3.2.2 GlobalProtect is configured for **always-on VPN** on company devices, meaning the VPN client activates automatically when the device is off-network. Employees must not disable or bypass GlobalProtect without an approved exception.

3.2.3 If GlobalProtect fails to connect, employees should attempt reconnection through the system tray icon. Persistent failures must be reported to the IT Service Desk. Internal resources must not be accessed via alternative means (personal VPN, proxy) while GlobalProtect is non-functional.

3.2.4 Use of third-party VPN services on company devices (NordVPN, ExpressVPN, etc.) is prohibited, as these may interfere with GlobalProtect and company security monitoring.

3.3 Home Network Security

3.3.1 Employees are strongly encouraged to use a **dedicated Wi-Fi band or VLAN** for work devices at home, separate from personal devices and IoT devices (smart TVs, home assistants, smart appliances).

3.3.2 Home routers must meet the following minimum requirements:

Requirement	Minimum Standard
Wi-Fi encryption	WPA2 or WPA3
Router firmware	Updated within the last 6 months
Default admin password	Changed from factory default

Remote management	Disabled unless explicitly needed
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3.3.3 Open, unencrypted Wi-Fi networks (cafes, hotels, airports) must not be used for company work without GlobalProtect VPN active and protecting all traffic.

3.3.4 Wired (Ethernet) connections are preferred where available for stability and security.

3.4 Physical Security in Remote Environments

3.4.1 Employees must position their screens so that company data is not visible to unauthorized individuals. Privacy screens are available for company laptops upon request from the IT Service Desk (REQ ticket on SummitDesk).

3.4.2 Confidential or Restricted documents must not be printed at home or in public locations (libraries, print shops). If remote printing of work documents is required, the employee must ensure the home printer is connected via a secure home network, retrieved immediately, and stored per POL-005.

3.4.3 Video conference calls involving Confidential or Restricted information must be conducted in a private space where the conversation cannot be overheard.

3.4.4 Smart speakers (Amazon Echo, Google Home, Apple HomePod) must not be present in the workspace during calls or meetings where sensitive company information is being discussed.

3.5 Remote Collaboration and Conferencing

3.5.1 Video and audio meetings must use **Zoom** or **Microsoft Teams** as the approved conferencing platforms. Consumer-grade conferencing tools (FaceTime for business calls, WhatsApp, personal Zoom free accounts) must not be used for company meetings involving Internal, Confidential, or Restricted information.

3.5.2 Screen sharing during video calls must be limited to relevant windows only ("window share" rather than "full desktop share") to avoid unintentionally displaying sensitive information.

3.5.3 Meeting recordings must be stored in approved company locations (Teams recording in SharePoint, Zoom recording uploaded to the appropriate SharePoint site or Teams channel). Recordings must not be stored in personal cloud storage.

3.6 Software Updates and Patch Management

3.6.1 Company devices are managed by Intune (Windows) and Jamf Pro (macOS) and receive automated patch deployment. Employees must not defer or decline OS and security updates pushed by Intune/Jamf for more than **7 days**. Devices with overdue patches will be quarantined from internal resources by Conditional Access.

3.6.2 Employees must restart their laptops at least once per week to allow pending updates to complete installation.

3.6.3 CrowdStrike Falcon must remain active and connected (sensor heartbeat monitored by IT Security). If a Falcon alert or quarantine action appears on the device, the employee must immediately notify the IT Service Desk.

3.7 Remote IT Support

3.7.1 Remote IT support is provided by the IT Service Desk during staffed hours (7:00 AM - 7:00 PM ET, Mon-Fri) via:

- Self-service portal: <https://help.summitit.com>
- Email: servicedesk@summitit.com
- Phone: +1 (800) 555-7866
- Slack: [#it-help](#)

3.7.2 For P1 (critical) issues outside staffed hours, call the 24/7 on-call line at +1 (800) 555-7866 and follow the prompts for after-hours support.

3.7.3 Remote support sessions may involve IT technicians connecting to the employee's device using an approved remote access tool. Employees must only allow connections initiated through official IT Service Desk communications. Do not grant remote access to anyone claiming to be IT without verifying via a known channel (call back the main IT number or check [#it-help](#)).

3.8 Expense and Equipment

3.8.1 Company-issued equipment is provided for remote work and remains the property of Summit IT Services. Employees must return equipment upon departure or upon IT request.

3.8.2 Home office IT peripherals (monitors, docking stations, keyboards, headsets) may be requested through SummitDesk under the "Remote Work Equipment Request" catalog item, subject to manager approval and budget availability.

3.8.3 Employees must not purchase IT equipment using personal funds and seek reimbursement without prior manager approval and a SummitDesk request for documentation purposes.

4. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
All Employees	Use company devices; keep VPN connected; secure home environment; report device loss immediately; accept IT updates promptly
Managers	Approve remote work arrangements; ensure team members have necessary equipment; report departing employees to HR/IT promptly
IT Service Desk (L1)	Provide remote support; process equipment requests; handle device loss reports
IT Security & Compliance	Own policy; maintain Conditional Access and VPN policies; monitor compliance; investigate incidents

L2 Desktop & Systems	Manage Intune/Jamf patch deployment; troubleshoot VPN issues remotely
L3 Engineering	Maintain GlobalProtect infrastructure; Conditional Access policies; monitor VPN health

5. Enforcement & Consequences

5.1 Intune and Okta Conditional Access automatically block non-compliant devices (out of date, non-managed) from accessing corporate resources.

5.2 Policy violations:

- **Using personal device for internal systems without BYOD approval:** Access revoked; device removed from network.
- **Disabling or bypassing GlobalProtect:** Formal written warning; access restricted; investigation.
- **Sharing device with non-employees:** Written warning; mandatory security training.
- **Failure to report device loss promptly:** Written warning; investigation of potential data exposure; costs of response may be assessed to the employee in cases of gross negligence.

6. Exceptions

Exceptions (e.g., accessing an internal system from a personal device due to an emergency) require:

1. Real-time notification to the IT Service Desk explaining the circumstance.
2. Formal exception request in SummitDesk within 24 hours.
3. IT Security review and CISO approval for ongoing exceptions.

7. Related Documents

- POL-001 - Acceptable Use Policy
- POL-003 - Multi-Factor Authentication Policy
- POL-004 - BYOD & Mobile Device Policy
- POL-005 - Data Classification & Handling Policy
- REF-0001 - Summit IT Environment Standards
- GlobalProtect VPN User Guide (internal wiki)

8. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	2020-04-01	IT Security	Initial release (COVID-19 remote work rollout)

2.0	2022-08-01	IT Security & Compliance	Formalized as standing policy; added Conditional Access and Intune compliance references
2.1	2023-06-15	IT Security & Compliance	Added smart speaker prohibition; updated conferencing tools
2.2	2024-03-01	IT Security & Compliance	Added always-on VPN policy; updated patch deferral window; added remote support fraud warning
2.3	2026-01-08	IT Security & Compliance	Annual review; updated VPN table; added wired Ethernet guidance; minor language clarifications